PORTFOLIO / VIDEO PRODUCTION

# Octopus:
# Connecting You and Us

## SCRIPT & SHOT LIST

| FORMAT | PLANNED RUNTIME | COVERAGE |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Student advertising video | 03:00 / 16:9 | 48 shots / 8 sequences |

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Production coordination, script and shot planning

*Unofficial collaborative student project. Not an Octopus-commissioned advertisement.*

# 01 / Creative Brief

## The idea

For someone new to Hong Kong, belonging happens gradually: at a railway gate, on a bus, over breakfast and alongside classmates. A repeated Octopus tap becomes the everyday sound linking a newcomer to the city and, eventually, to other people.

## Logline

A newcomer gradually finds a place in Hong Kong through daily Octopus transactions, gains friends, and one day helps another newcomer take their own first step.

## Narrative arc

| 01 ARRIVAL | 02 ROUTINE | 03 BELONGING | 04 RETURN |
|---|---|---|---|
| An outsider pauses | The taps become easier | Friends wait and walk together | Helping the next newcomer |

## Sound as narrative device

The Octopus reader's "beep" recurs as a sound motif and edit point. Early taps are isolated and hesitant. As the protagonist becomes confident, beeps sync with a faster montage; the final pair of taps turns "You" into "Us."

## Reading this document

This is a pre-production script and planned shot list: timings are approximate, optional coverage is marked where relevant, and the final edit may differ. This document does not claim that every listed shot was filmed.

*Project credited as a collaborative student production. Portfolio role: production coordination, script development and shot planning.*

## Production considerations

Plan coverage by location; maintain distinct wardrobe looks and prop continuity between the arrival and familiar-city phases. Capture clean tap sound, brief recording handles, and natural interactions without obstructing passengers or services. Confirm filming permission where required.

# 02 / Narrative Script

### A–B / Arrival and the first tap

A new student stands still while Hong Kong moves around them. They check signs and maps, then watch commuters use Octopus at the gate. After a moment of hesitation, their first clear tap opens the gate and the journey begins.

### C / Building a routine

The same card is used to board a bus and buy breakfast. Familiarity grows with each ordinary transaction.

### D / Meeting people

The student enters class alone. A classmate asks to sit down; later, they leave together with new friends. Three quick taps turn an individual movement into a shared rhythm.

### E–F / The city becomes home

Octopus use is now effortless at gates, buses, convenience stores, restaurants and shops. Everyday moments compress into a fast sound-led montage before giving way to slower images of friendship.

### G / Seeing the earlier self

At a familiar station, the protagonist notices another person with luggage looking lost. The newcomer mirrors the opening shot. Remembering their own arrival, the protagonist approaches and offers help.

### H / Connecting You and Us

The newcomer taps for the first time; the protagonist taps beside them. The two walk together into the crowd. The film closes on the Octopus title: “Connecting You and Us.”

### SELECTED VOICEOVER THREAD

“When I first arrived in Hong Kong, so much was unfamiliar.” → “Later, it wasn’t just the routes that became familiar.” → “I had become the person I wished I’d met.”

# 03 / Shot-by-Shot Plan

48 PLANNED SHOTS • TIME CODES REFER TO APPROXIMATE POSITION IN THE 180-SECOND CUT

## A / NEW TO THE CITY 00:00–00:24

*A newcomer is out of step with a city already moving.*

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| A1 | 00:00-00:04 | Quick establishing cuts: Hong Kong rail, buses, crowded streets, signs and high-rises. | Urban ambience, footsteps and traffic; very light piano. | Approx. one second per cut; city already in motion. |
| A2 | 00:04-00:09 | Newcomer with suitcase or large bag stands still beside a moving crowd. | Suitcase wheels; footsteps. | Contrast surrounding movement with the protagonist's pause; back/side angle. |
| A3 | 00:09-00:14 | Newcomer checks a map on their phone, looks up and searches for directions. | VO: "When I first arrived in Hong Kong, so much was unfamiliar." | Cut between phone, face and wayfinding signs. |
| A4 | 00:14-00:20 | At the MTR gates, protagonist watches others tap Octopus and walk through effortlessly. | Distant, understated tap tones. VO: "The routes, the directions, and the rhythm of life here." | Observe first; do not tap yet. |
| A5 | 00:20-00:24 | Close-up: Octopus card approaches the reader, but stops just before tapping. | Ambient sound fades; brief musical pause. | Hold the hesitation before the first clear tap. |

## B / THE FIRST TAP 00:24–00:48

*A single sound marks the first small step into Hong Kong daily life.*

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| B1 | 00:24-00:28 | Hand close-up: protagonist hesitantly touches their Octopus card to the reader. | First prominent "beep". | Keep sound and tap action especially clean. |
| B2 | 00:28-00:32 | Gate opens; protagonist pauses for an instant, then moves forward. | Beep resonance; score begins. | A subtle sense of relief; no exaggerated acting. |
| B3 | 00:32-00:37 | Low-angle shot of feet and suitcase moving through the gate. | Suitcase wheels; footsteps. | A visual threshold into everyday life in Hong Kong. |
| B4 | 00:37-00:42 | Protagonist arrives on the platform as a train pulls in and doors open. | Train arrival; doors opening. | Possible match cut from gate opening to train doors. |

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| B5 | 00:42-00:48 | In the train: protagonist looks at a phone map, then out the window. | VO: “Later, I found settling into life here might not be as hard as I imagined.” | Use window reflections if possible; slightly more relaxed mood. |

## C / DAILY ROUTINES 00:48–01:10

*Transport and breakfast transactions become familiar.*

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| C1 | 00:48-00:54 | At a bus stop, protagonist checks the route number; the bus arrives. | Bus stop and street ambience. | Show some remaining uncertainty about route-finding. |
| C2 | 00:54-00:58 | Protagonist boards the bus and taps Octopus. | “Beep.” | More natural and confident than the first MTR tap. |
| C3 | 00:58-01:03 | Bus window seat: checks map once, then looks at the passing city. | Driving sound; music becomes lighter. | Echo b5, but show increasing ease. |
| C4 | 01:03-01:07 | At a convenience-store counter, protagonist sets down breakfast items. | Convenience-store ambience. | Simple, everyday purchase; no need to show full transaction. |
| C5 | 01:07-01:10 | Close-up of Octopus payment at the counter. | “Beep.” | Clear, concise payment action. |

## D / PEOPLE AND CONNECTIONS 01:10–01:32

*A classroom acquaintance becomes a circle of friends.*

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| D1 | 01:10-01:15 | Protagonist walks alone into campus or a teaching building. | Campus ambience. | Maintain visual theme of being alone. |
| D2 | 01:15-01:19 | Alone in class, protagonist opens a laptop or notebook; adjacent seat is empty. | Natural classroom sound. | Make the empty seat visible. |
| D3 | 01:19-01:23 | A classmate approaches and takes the seat beside the protagonist. | Classmate: “Is anyone sitting here?” / Protagonist: “No.” | Natural, understated performance. |
| D4 | 01:23-01:27 | Time jump: protagonist leaves the building chatting with two or three classmates. | VO: “Later, it wasn’t just the routes that became familiar. It was the people I saw every day.” | Mirror d1: one person becomes a group. |

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| D5 | 01:27-01:29 | First classmate taps through MTR gate. | “Beep.” | Begin sync with the musical beat. |
| D6 | 01:29-01:30.5 | Second classmate taps through. | “Beep.” | Fast cut; maintain matching composition. |
| D7 | 01:30.5-01:32 | Protagonist taps through and catches up with friends. | “Beep.” | Three quick beeps form a rhythm. |

## E / SECOND NATURE 01:32–01:56

*A rhythmic montage turns cautious movements into instinct.*

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| E1 | 01:32-01:35 | Protagonist taps through MTR gates while continuing to chat with a friend. | “Beep.” | No longer looks ahead nervously at the reader. |
| E2 | 01:35-01:38 | Match-cut to a bus: protagonist taps Octopus as they board. | “Beep.” | Match hand movement with e1. |
| E3 | 01:38-01:41 | At convenience-store counter, sets down an item and immediately pays. | “Beep.” | Repeat a similar hand gesture. |
| E4 | 01:41-01:44 | After eating with friends, protagonist pays with Octopus. | “Beep.” | Show a dining-related transaction. |
| E5 | 01:44-01:47 | Pays for a small retail purchase and collects a shopping bag. | “Beep.” | Broaden the everyday use cases. |
| E6 | 01:47-01:51 | Walks through MTR gate while chatting, barely looking at the reader. | “Beep.” | Strong contrast with a4–a5 hesitation. |
| E7 | 01:51-01:52 | Protagonist and friends hurry to catch a bus or train. | Music accelerates. | Very quick one-second montage shot. |
| E8 | 01:52-01:53 | Packs up laptop or books after class. | Music continues. | One-second everyday-life montage. |
| E9 | 01:53-01:54 | A friend casually hands the protagonist a drink or small item. | Music continues. | Communicate easy familiarity and friendship. |
| E10 | 01:54-01:55 | Train doors open; people begin moving. | Door chime. | Fast montage cut. |
| E11 | 01:55-01:56 | Protagonist and friends walk naturally into the crowd. | Music transitions into the next section. | End the fast montage; no one looks at camera. |

## F / FROM YOU TO US 01:56–02:18

*The rhythm of the city is now shared with friends.*

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| F1 | 01:56-02:01 | A friend who has passed the gate turns back to wait; protagonist taps and catches up. | "Beep." | The focus is no longer the card: someone is waiting. |
| F2 | 02:01-02:06 | Friends eat and talk together. | Natural conversation, laughter, restaurant ambience. | Candid interactions are preferable to scripted acting. |
| F3 | 02:06-02:10 | Friends walk together through Hong Kong streets at night. | VO: "When did these places begin to feel familiar?" | Warm mood; follow from behind or side. |
| F4 | 02:10-02:14 | If practical, protagonist makes a tap with Mobile Octopus; physical card is acceptable. | "Beep." VO: "I'm not sure I could say." | Optional insert; avoid forcing a technical setup. |
| F5 | 02:14-02:18 | Three or four friends continue walking together, camera following from behind. | Music gradually slows. | Lengthen the shot to contrast with fast e-montage. |

## G / SEEING AN EARLIER SELF 02:18–02:42

*The protagonist recognizes a new arrival's uncertainty.*

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| G1 | 02:18-02:23 | Protagonist walks confidently through a familiar station or street without checking directions. | Urban ambience comes forward again. | Demonstrate ease in the city. |
| G2 | 02:23-02:27 | Protagonist notices another newcomer with suitcase, standing aside to check a map. | Suitcase-wheel sound becomes more noticeable. | Echo the opening framing of a2–a3. |
| G3 | 02:27-02:31 | Brief flashback to protagonist arriving alone; return to the new arrival. | Music recedes. | Repeat opening visual geometry to connect the two arrivals. |
| G4 | 02:31-02:35 | Protagonist approaches and offers directions. | Protagonist: "Where are you going?" / Newcomer answers. / Protagonist: "This way. I'm heading in that direction too." | Keep exchange short and natural. |
| G5 | 02:35-02:42 | Protagonist and newcomer walk together toward the gates, suitcase in frame. | VO: "Only later did I realize... I had become the person I wished I'd met when | Opening: one person with luggage; now: two walking together. |

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | I first arrived." | |

## H / CONNECTING YOU AND US 02:42–03:00

*Two taps and two figures moving forward complete the circle.*

| ID | TIME | PICTURE / ACTION | AUDIO / DIALOGUE | DIRECTION / FOCUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| H1 | 02:42-02:47 | At the gate, newcomer hesitates. Protagonist points out where to tap. | Primarily ambient sound; music held back. | Direct callback to a5. |
| H2 | 02:47-02:51 | Newcomer taps Octopus for the first time. | "Beep." | A first tap for the new arrival. |
| H3 | 02:51-02:55 | Protagonist taps at the next gate and enters alongside the newcomer. | "Beep." | Two close beeps: "You" becomes "Us." |
| H4 | 02:55-02:58 | Camera stays in place as both figures walk into the moving crowd. | VO: "With each simple tap, the unfamiliar gradually becomes everyday life." | Reverse the opening image of being left outside the flow. |
| H5 | 02:58-03:00 | Fade to Octopus branding and the title "Connecting You and Us." | Music resolves; optional quiet final beep. | End card created in post-production. |